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EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

At first I discussed some ideas for the EE (which I want to do on Maths) with my supervisor. The only idea I had at that point was to do something on rocket science. This seemed like a good idea, because, besides mathematics rocket science has a lot of physics as well, and that's the science I study. Furthermore, it's a topic I was really interested in learning about. However, there was a big problem, rocket science is too broad for a theme. Despite being excited, I hadn't a specific goal; I was very lost. This way, my first meeting with my supervisor was a bit 'empty' and we hadn't a lot to talk about. The big problem was, I didn't know much about rocket science but I was looking forward to researching it and I had a feeling I would eventually be able to find a clearer goal for my EE. Consequently I ended up wasting a lot of my time with this theme and wasn't able to go forward with the EE for months.

Later on, things improved. I had written almost nothing apart from the structure of the work. However I had found a new theme – the Goat Problem. This problem was perfect for my EE because it had to do with my favourite areas of mathematics: geometry, algebra and calculus. At this point I had basically worked out (almost) all of the maths that was going to be used in the work on some sheets of paper, I just needed to start my write up. A discussion with my supervisor ended up being very simple and quick since all I had were some calculations. I basically got approval from my supervisor to continue working on this theme and I asked some questions about what would/wouldn't be interesting to include in the EE (maths-wise) and to which lengths should I go in each part of the exploration. This was helpful as I then had an idea of how to start writing, in a way that I could build a path: each topic of the work would lead to the next one, which would make the work as a whole better to read.

Finally, I had the work done and just some tiny doubts. In the viva, I went through the whole work, explaining it to my supervisor who asked me some questions. The questions were basically regarding nomenclature and mathematical terminology and some small things related to the structure. In the end, I was very relieved because my supervisor approved it and appeared to be happy with what I'd done. I was also very happy because although it took me so much time to get started (which was very stressful), I feel like I've done a great work. The only thing missing for me was to find the right theme.

(481 words)

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